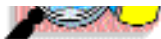


Microsoft

If you frequently customise Office applications to suit your needs—especially Word and Excel—you will certainly feel the pinch when reinstalling if you haven’t backed up the configuration settings. Usually, one remembers this only after one starts using it again, when it is too late.

There are several ways to back up Word settings. You can simply copy the templates from the Templates folder and copy them back after reinstalling. Thus, you can prevent the headache of recreating all templates from scratch. To find out where the templates are stored in Word, either click **File > Save As** and change the ‘Save as’ type to Document Template, or click **Tools > Options > File Locations**. Taking a backup of templates will not only copy the styles, headers, footers, text and images in the template, it will also copy the document properties, toolbar settings, shortcut keys and macros that you have created. Templates also store all your AutoText entries.

Similarly, taking backups of Excel templates will save characteristics of workbooks and worksheets such as the number and type of sheets in a workbook, cell and sheet formats, cell styles, page formats and print area settings for each sheet, repeating text such as page headers and row and column labels, data, formulae, graphics, etc. The templates also store custom



toolbars, macros, hyperlinks and ActiveX controls on forms, protected and hidden areas of the workbook, calculation options and window display options.

Apart from template settings, you can also back up AutoCorrect lists and custom dictionaries in Word. Word stores AutoCorrect entries in an ACL file. Typically, the filename is the name of the user logged on to Windows. Thus, if you log on to Windows as Administrator, you should be able to find a file named Administrator.acl that stores the list. The dictionaries are stored in DIC files. The default dictionary is named custom.dic.

All versions of Office can be set up in such a way that it is possible to automatically install with custom selections without filling up dialog boxes. You can select the type of installation, components, installation folders, etc. For Office 97, the tab-delimited STF file specifies where and in what order files are copied and what registry entries are created. The INF file contains descriptions of Office files, which are used by the STF file to determine which files to copy. The instructions in the Setup.1st file provide installation parameters. For Office 2000, installation settings are read from an MST file and running setup with the /qb- parameter suppresses all dialog boxes—you will not have to click



Automatically back up Office settings

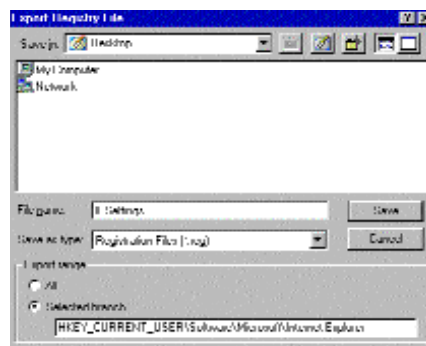
anywhere through the installation process. Note that these will not restore any customised settings, but are great for repeat custom installs.

Almost all program settings for Office are stored in the Windows Registry, HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Office. You can export this key to a file and later import it back to the Registry after reinstalling the same version of Office with default settings. Microsoft included the perfect tool for Office 97 and XP. Called the Save My Settings wizard, it takes a backup of almost all settings and saves it to the Web or to a file. You can later restore these settings with the same wizard. The tool is bundled with Office XP; for Office 2000 you can download it from <http://office.microsoft.com/downloads/2000/o2ksmsdd.aspx>.

Internet and E-

How many of us have lost our bookmarks after reinstalling Windows? This is one of the first things you miss when you start browsing. To back up favourites, simply copy the files off the Favorites folder. In a single-user environment, this is located in the Windows installation folder; otherwise you will be able to find it within the user’s profile.

If you customise Internet Explorer quite a bit (security, connection, browser behaviour, etc), you would want to save its settings too. Most settings are stored in the Registry. You can take a backup of the HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Internet Explorer branch. To do this, open the Registry Editor by running regedit, navigate to this branch and click **Registry > Export Registry File**. When you want to restore these settings, first make sure that



Save IE settings from the Registry

the same version of Internet Explorer is installed, then double-click the registry file that you took a backup of. Reboot the machine and the settings will be restored.

What all should you save when backing up e-mail? This is the most common

dilemma most of us face. You don’t just mail the store itself, but all mail items such as identities, rules and filters. If you use Outlook, you will be able to export Outlook settings in a PRF file. Outlook stores the Personal Address Book in a PAB file, the Outlook Bar shortcuts in FA files and message rules in RWZ files. Names and addresses are stored in NICK and NK2 files. Print settings in an OutlPrnt file, toolbar settings in Outcmd.dat and system settings in Views.dat. Macro settings are stored in VbaProject.otm files. Send/Receive group settings are in a .grp file. Signatures are linked from RTF and TXT files, templates are saved as .dot files and Junk and Adult Senders lists are in files named Junk Senders.txt and Adult Senders.txt.

You can back up the Account se